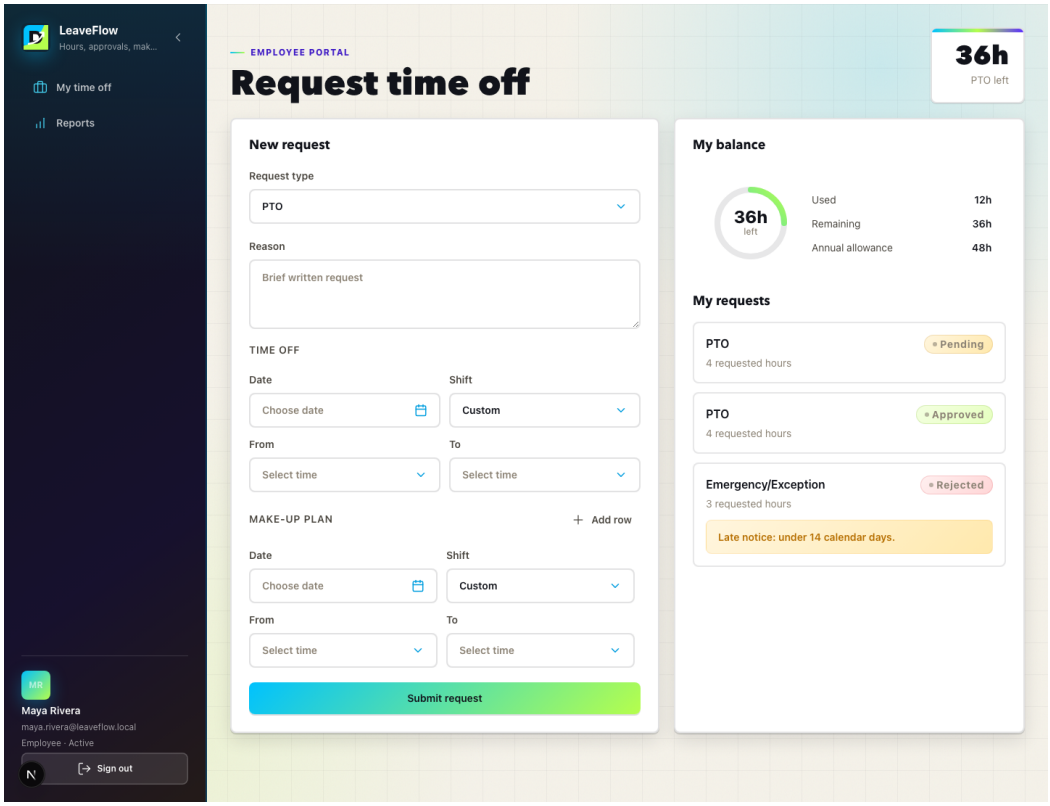
LeaveFlow Standard Operating Procedure

Hour-based PTO, approvals, make-up verification, reporting, and access control

Audience	Employees and Admins who submit, review, approve, verify, or report on LeaveFlow requests.
Screenshot data	Sanitized demo data only. Names, emails, requests, and balances in this SOP are examples.
Policy defaults	48 annual PTO hours, hour-based requests, 14-day late-notice flag, and make-up plans for additional time off.
System scope	Google sign-in, Employee portal, Admin dashboard, Reports, audit logs, Gmail notifications, and day-before reminders.



Employee portal overview with balance, request form, and request history.

1. Operating Model

LeaveFlow manages time off in hours. Employees submit dated time blocks, Admins approve or reject requests, and additional time off requires a make-up plan with dated from/to work blocks. Approved PTO deducts from the employee balance. Make-up entries remain separately verifiable so Admins can confirm whether coverage was worked.

Role	Primary responsibilities	Typical screens
Employee	Sign in, review PTO balance, submit PTO or additional time off, add make-up rows, and monitor request status.	Employee portal, request form, My requests.
Admin	Activate users, assign roles, review requests, update annual PTO, verify make-up entries, and review reports/audit events.	Admin dashboard, Reports.
Pending user	Can sign in with Google but cannot access workflows until an Admin activates the profile.	Pending access screen.

Standard workflow

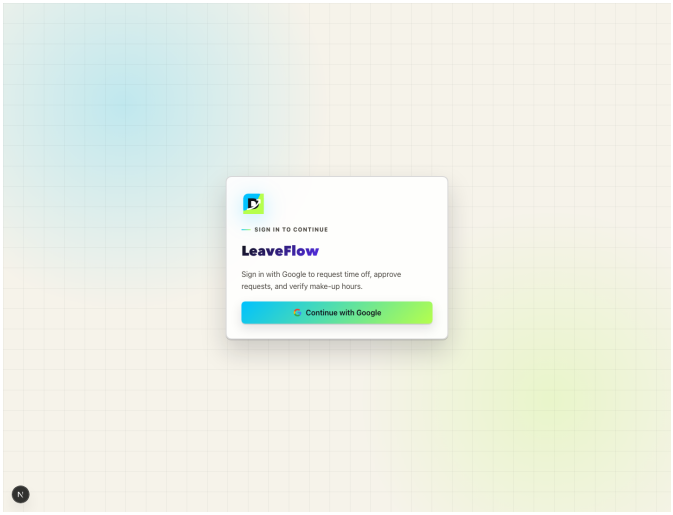
1. Employee signs in with Google. New or unapproved accounts land in Pending access.
2. Employee submits a PTO, Additional Time Off, or Emergency/Exception request with a reason and exact time-off range.
3. If the request is not PTO, the employee adds one or more make-up rows with date, from time, and to time.
4. Admin reviews pending approvals, approves or rejects the request, and later marks make-up entries as Worked or Not Worked.
5. Reports show approved off/make-up calendar events, employee profile metrics, make-up work, and audit logs.

Control note: duplicate submissions are blocked when the exact same request already exists, and the employee sees a duplicate notice instead of creating a second copy.

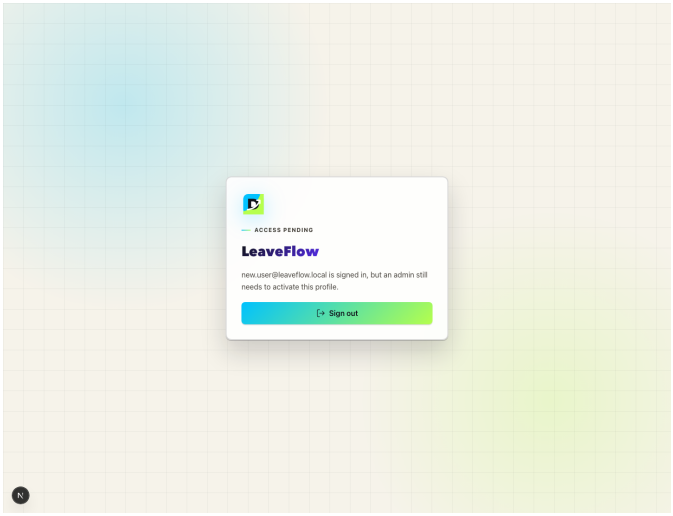
2. Access And Sign-In

Sign-in procedure

1. Open LeaveFlow and select Continue with Google.
2. Use the approved workplace Google account. Do not share accounts or submit requests for another user.
3. After authentication, Active Employees land on the Employee portal. Active Admins can also open Admin and Reports from the sidebar.
4. If the account is new, the user sees Access pending. An Admin must activate the profile before the user can proceed.



Google sign-in entry point.



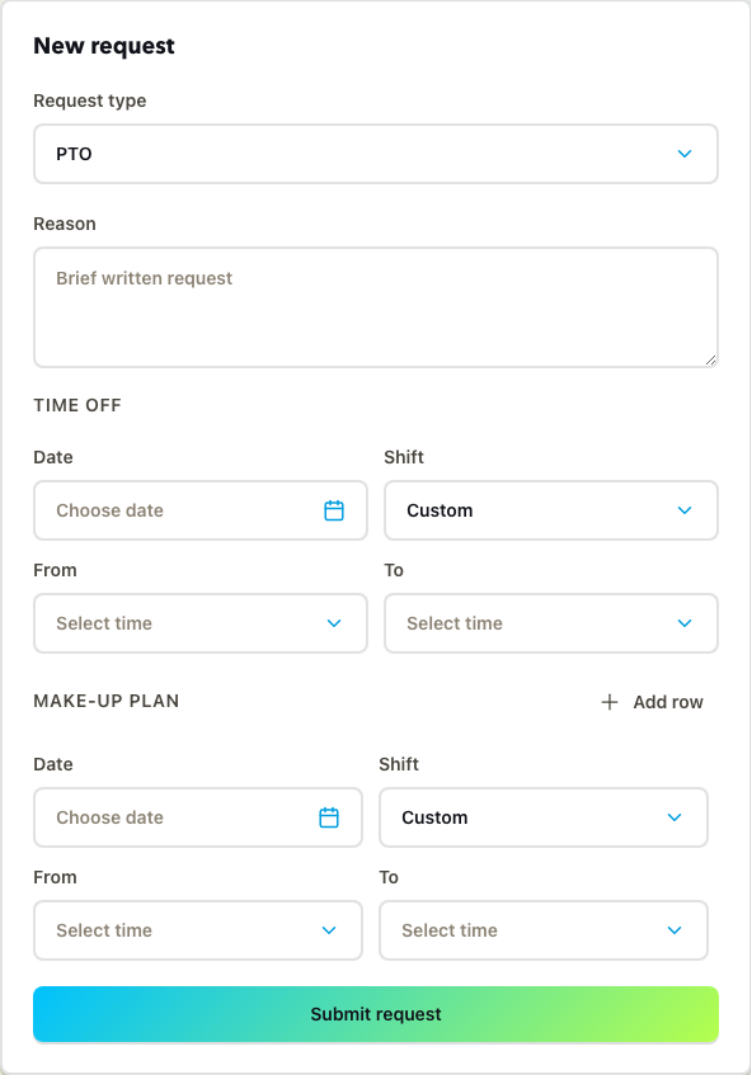
Pending access state for a newly signed-in user.

Admin activation procedure

1. Open Admin from the sidebar.
2. Find the user under User roles.
3. Set Status to Active when the user is authorized to use LeaveFlow.
4. Set Role to Employee for standard PTO users or Admin only for staff who should manage approvals, roles, allowances, and reports.
5. Select Save and confirm the user can refresh or sign in again to reach the correct portal.

3. Employee Request Procedure

Employees should submit requests as soon as the need is known. LeaveFlow flags requests with less than 14 calendar days of notice so Admins can review coverage risk.



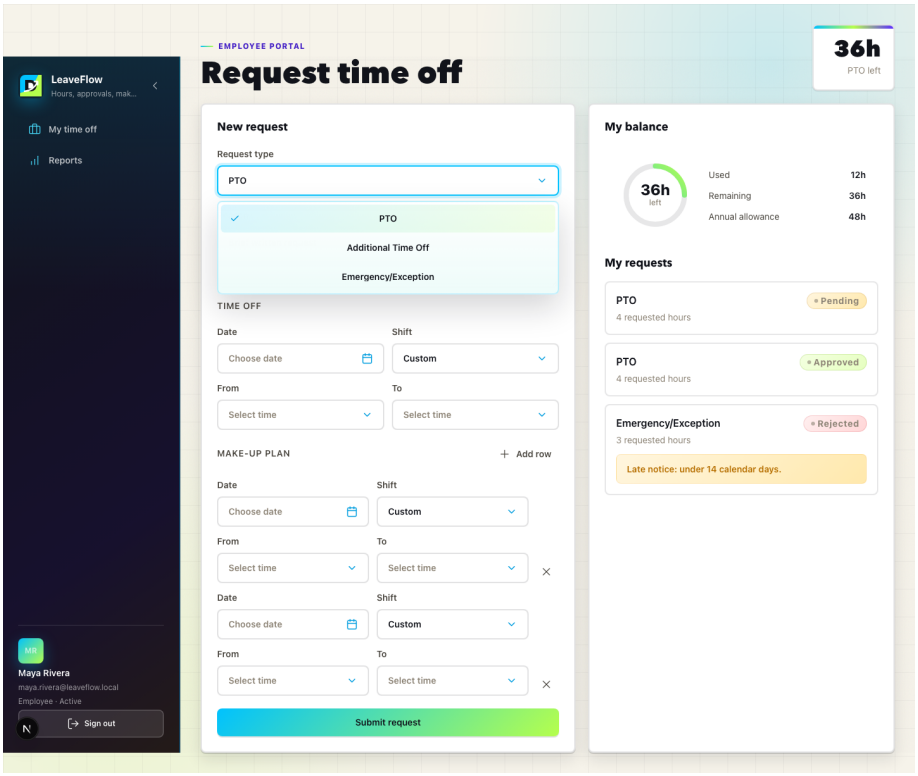
New request form with request type, reason, time-off range, make-up plan, and submit button.

Submit PTO

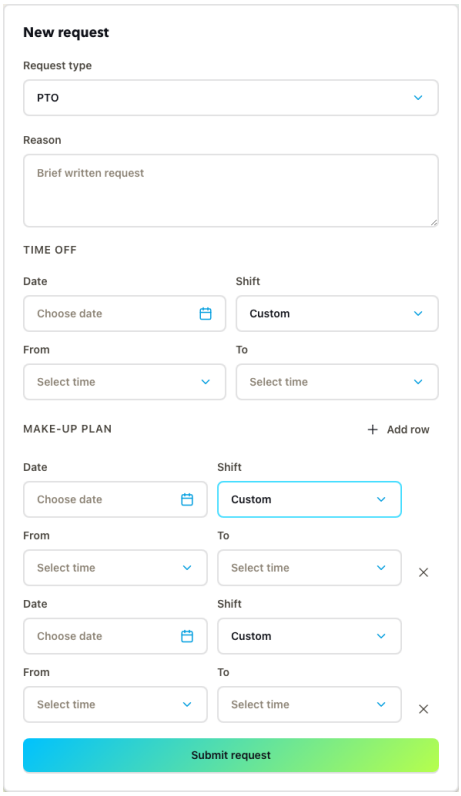
1. Confirm the PTO balance shown on My balance.
2. Choose Request type: PTO.
3. Enter a concise reason that gives Admins enough context to review coverage.
4. Select the time-off date, shift preset or Custom, and the exact From and To times.
5. Leave the make-up plan blank unless the request type requires make-up work.
6. Select Submit request and wait for the success message before navigating away.

3.1 Additional Time Off And Make-Up Plans

Use this procedure for Additional Time Off or Emergency/Exception requests. Non-PTO requests require make-up details before they can be submitted.



Request type menu showing PTO, Additional Time Off, and Emergency/Exception.



Multiple make-up rows for separate make-up dates or time blocks.

Make-up plan procedure

1. Change Request type from PTO to Additional Time Off or Emergency/Exception.
2. Enter the requested time-off date and exact time range.
3. Under Make-up plan, add one row for each planned make-up work block.
4. For every make-up row, enter date, shift or Custom time, From, and To.
5. Use Add row for multiple make-up dates. Remove mistaken rows with the X control.
6. Submit only after all partial rows are complete. Partial make-up rows are rejected by validation.

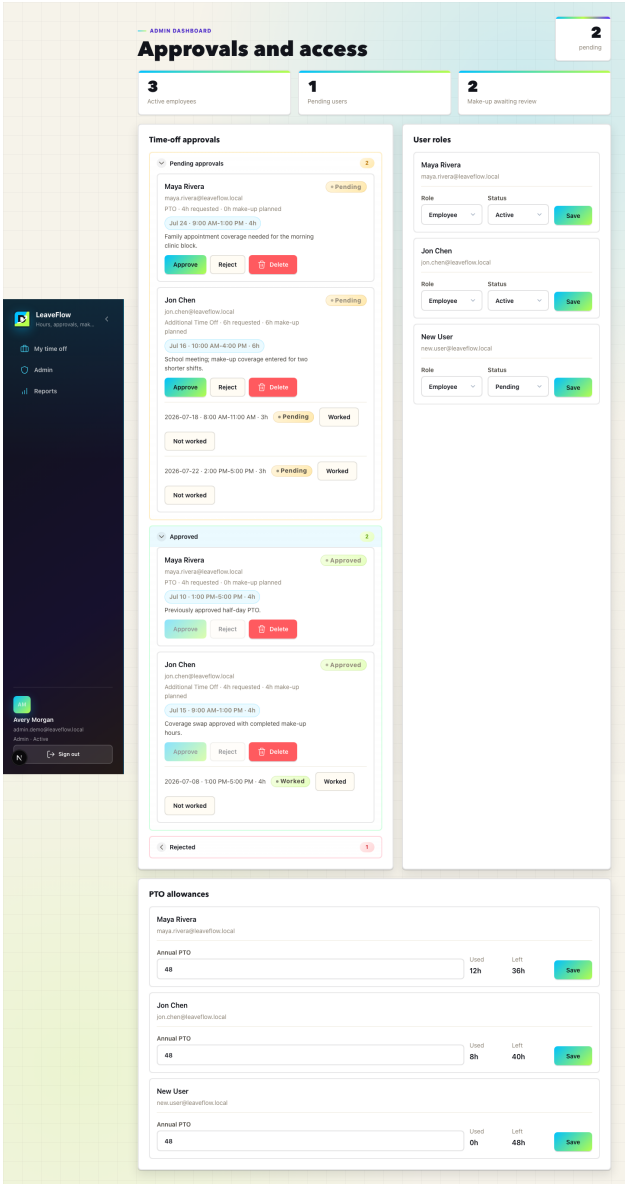
Important: make-up hours do not automatically count as worked. An Admin must verify each entry as Worked or Not Worked.

Track request status

- Pending means an Admin has not made a decision yet.
- Approved means PTO is accepted. Approved PTO requests deduct used hours from the applicable balance.
- Rejected means the request was not accepted. Rejected requests stay visible for context.
- Late notice appears when the request date is fewer than 14 calendar days away.

4. Admin Approvals And Access

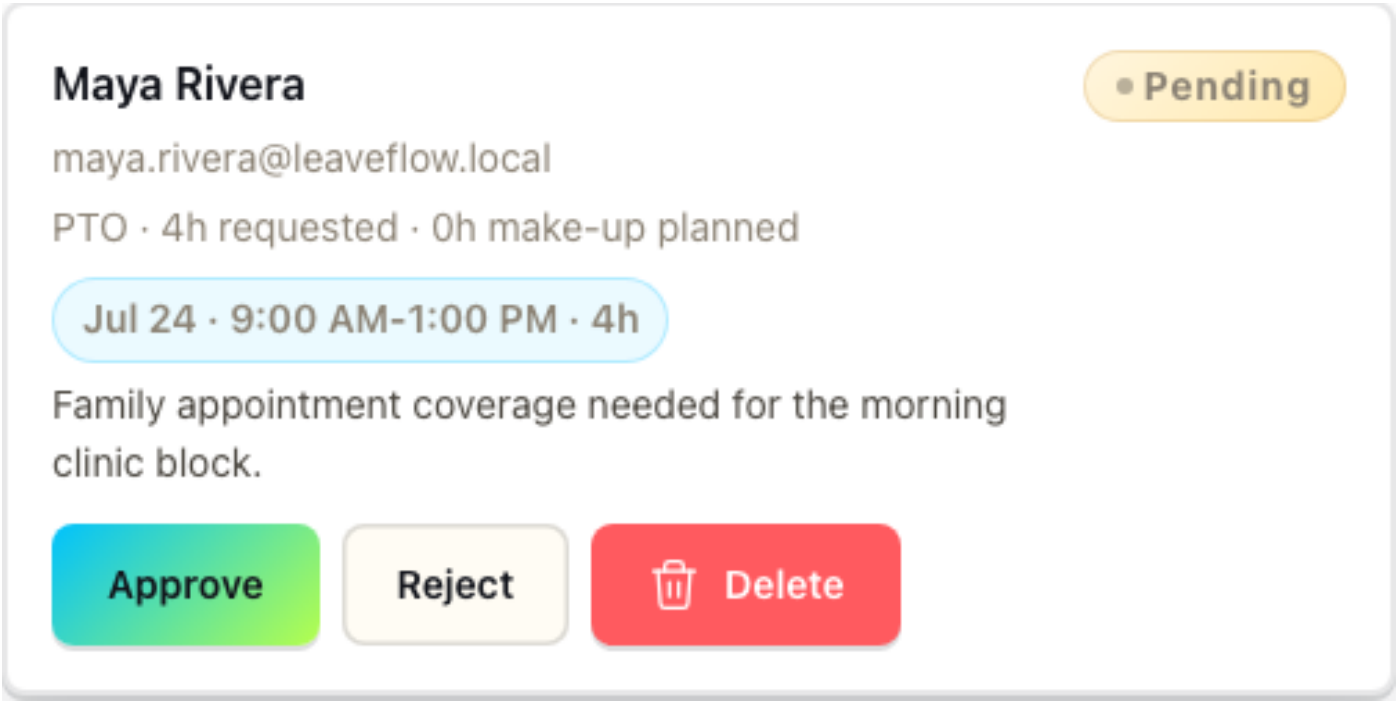
Admins use the dashboard to manage daily operational decisions: who has access, which requests need review, whether make-up work was completed, and whether employee PTO balances need adjustment.



Admin dashboard with expanded pending and approved approval groups, user roles, and PTO allowances.

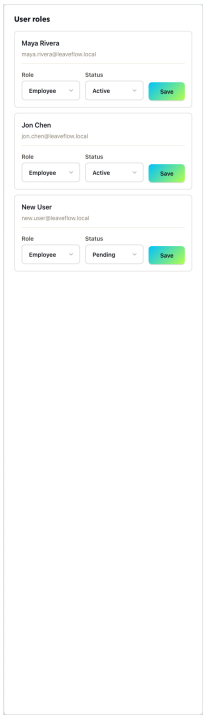
Approve or reject a request

1. Open Admin and review the metric cards for pending requests, pending users, and make-up awaiting review.
2. Open Pending approvals. Read the employee name, email, request type, requested hours, make-up hours, requested time, and reason.
3. For PTO, confirm the balance and coverage impact. For additional time off, confirm the make-up plan is complete and realistic.
4. Select Approve to accept the request or Reject when coverage, policy, or make-up details do not support approval.
5. Use Delete only when the record should be permanently removed. Deleting an approved PTO request recalculates the employee balance.



Admin request card with request decision and make-up verification controls.

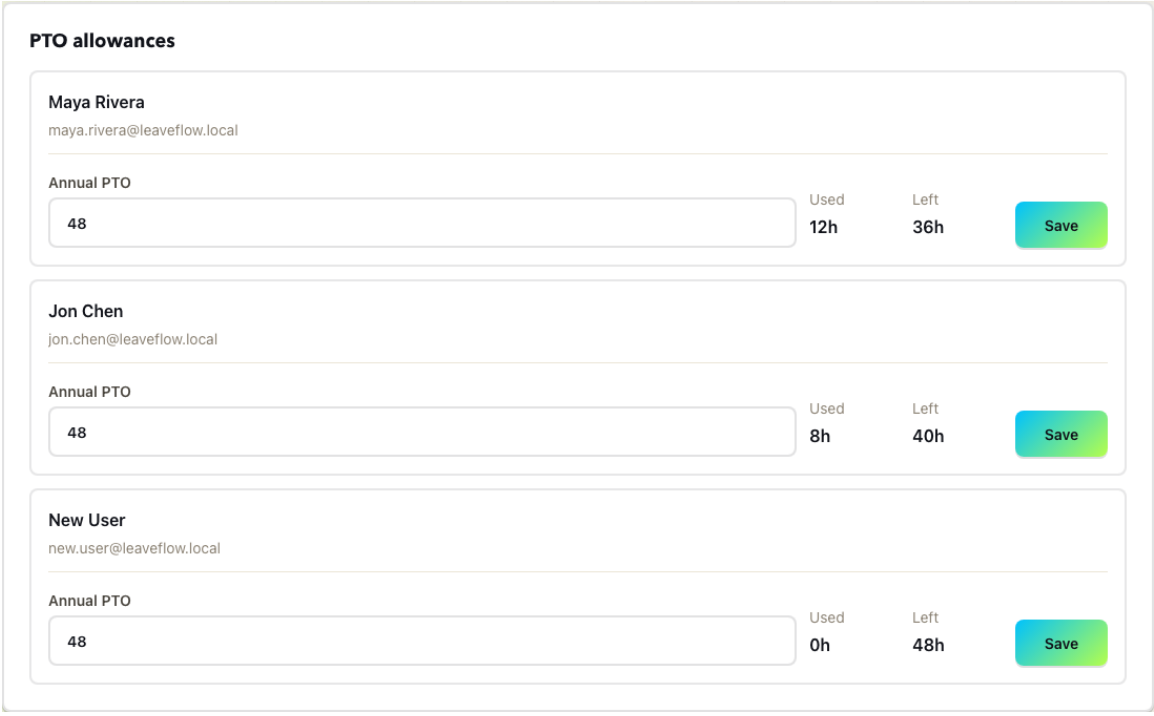
4.1 User Roles And PTO Allowances



User role and status controls for Active, Pending, and Admin/Employee access.

User role procedure

1. Use Employee for staff who submit or track their own requests.
2. Use Admin only for authorized staff who need access management and request approval authority.
3. Use Pending for new users awaiting review.
4. Use Disabled when a user should no longer access LeaveFlow.
5. Select Save after any role or status change.



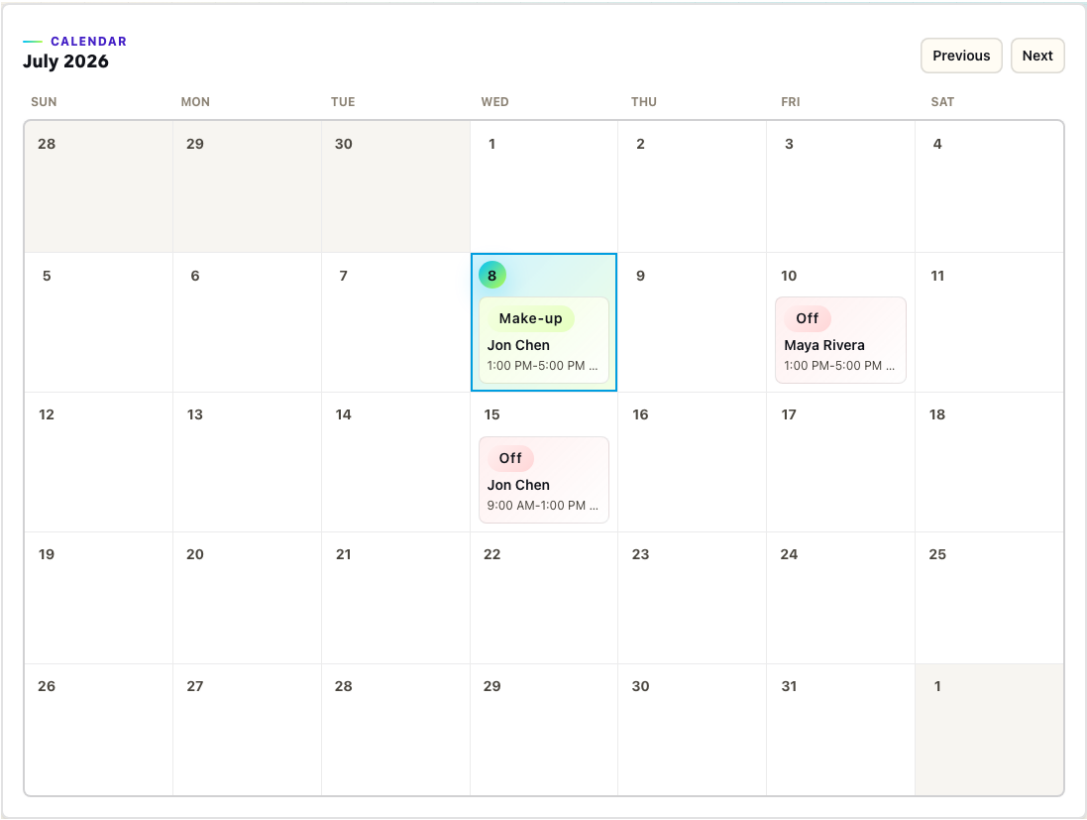
Annual PTO allowance controls with used and remaining hours.

PTO allowance procedure

1. Open PTO allowances on the Admin dashboard.
2. Review the employee, annual PTO, used hours, and left hours.
3. Enter the updated annual allowance in hours, using quarter-hour increments if needed.
4. Select Save. Confirm the balance shown to the employee reflects the change.

5. Reports, Calendar, And Audit Review

Reports provide the operational record for approved time off, make-up work, employee status, and audit events. Admins should use Reports before staffing discussions, payroll checks, and follow-up on make-up work.

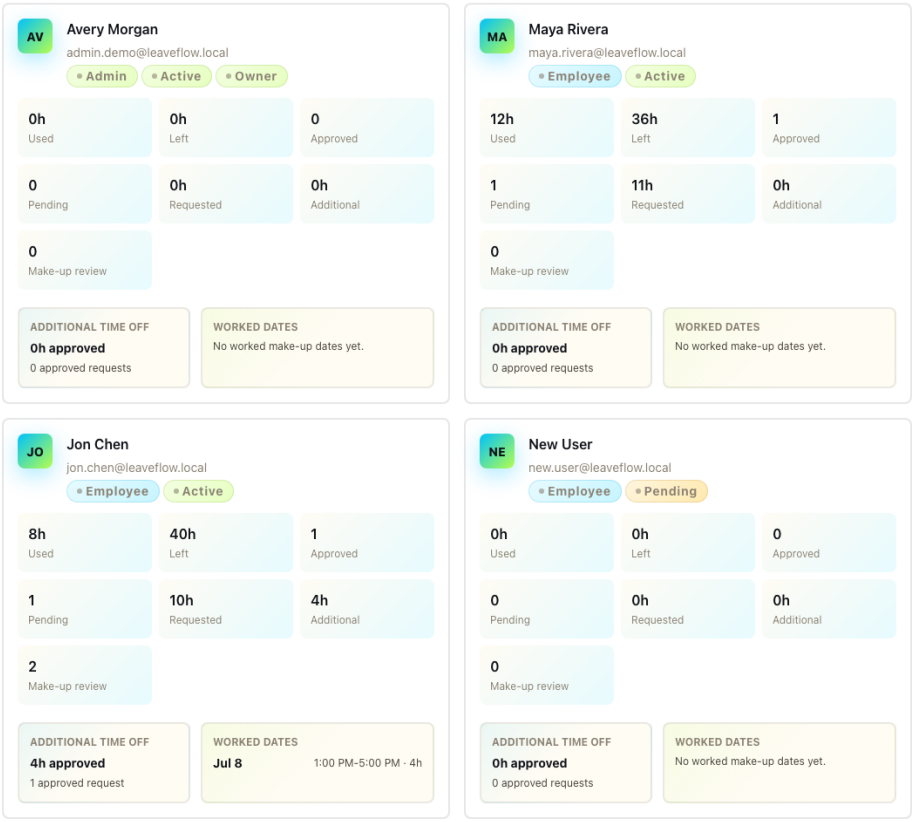


Monthly calendar showing approved off blocks and approved make-up work.

Calendar procedure

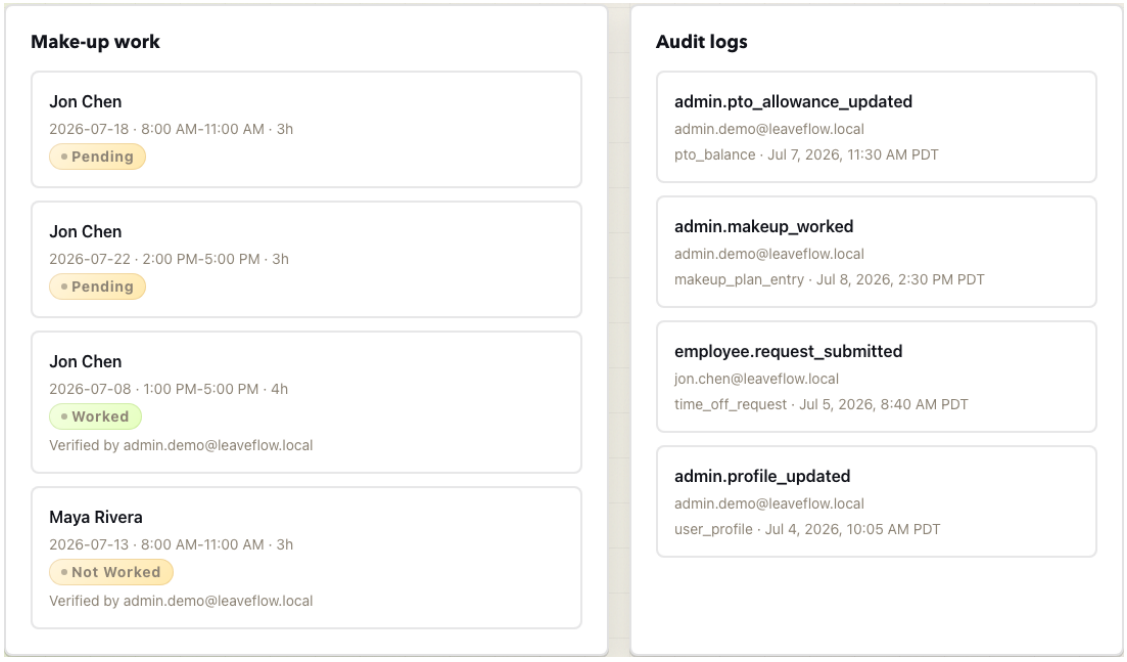
1. Open Reports from the sidebar.
2. Use Previous and Next to move between months.
3. Review Off pins for approved requested time off.
4. Review Make-up pins for approved requests with make-up work.
5. Use employee names, times, and hours to coordinate coverage and reminder follow-up.

5.1 Employee Profiles, Make-Up Work, And Audit Logs



Employee profile cards with balance, status, additional time off, and worked-date metrics.

- Used and Left summarize PTO balance impact.
- Approved and Pending count request status by employee.
- Requested and Additional show hour totals for trend review.
- Make-up review counts pending verification work.
- Worked dates list verified make-up work.



Reports panels for make-up work and audit events.

- Make-up work lists planned hours and verification status across requests.
- Audit logs show the action, actor email, target type, and timestamp.
- Use audit logs to confirm who changed roles, updated allowances, submitted requests, or verified make-up work.

6. Notifications, Reminders, And Troubleshooting

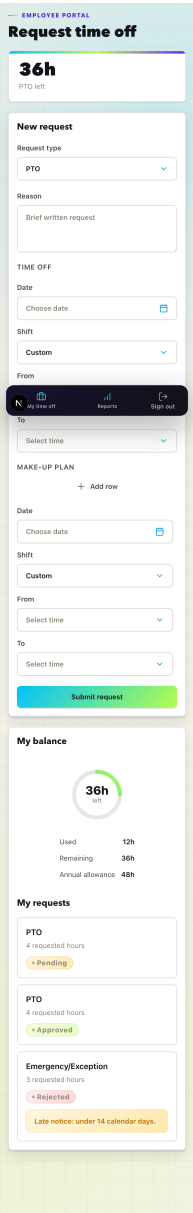
Topic	Operational expectation	What to check if it fails
New request email	Active Admins receive a notification when a new non-duplicate request is submitted.	Confirm Gmail API environment variables and active Admin profiles.
Decision email	Employee receives an email after approval or rejection.	Confirm employee email, Gmail configuration, and server logs.
Day-before reminders	Approved days off and make-up plans can trigger reminders through the cron endpoint.	Confirm CRON_SECRET, NEXT_PUBLIC_APP_URL, and the Vercel cron schedule.
Auth setup	Google sign-in requires Better Auth, Google OAuth credentials, and PostgreSQL schema.	Confirm BETTER_AUTH_SECRET, BETTER_AUTH_URL, GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID, GOOGLE_CLIENT_SECRET, DATABASE_URL, and sql/schema.sql.
Request validation	Start must be before end, required fields must be present, and non-PTO requests require make-up entries.	Review the on-screen error and correct missing date/time fields.
Duplicate notice	Exact duplicate requests are not resubmitted.	If a new request is needed, change the date, time, reason, or make-up plan as appropriate.

Routine Admin checklist

- Daily: review Pending approvals and Make-up awaiting review.
- Weekly: review Reports for upcoming off days, make-up work, and audit events.
- When onboarding: activate the user, assign role, and confirm first successful access.
- When changing balances: update PTO allowance and confirm used/left totals.
- When investigating a discrepancy: compare request cards, report profile metrics, make-up work, and audit logs.

Appendix A. Mobile Layout Reference

LeaveFlow is responsive. On narrow screens the sidebar becomes a compact navigation surface and form fields stack for touch-friendly use. Employees can still review their balance, submit requests, and check statuses from a phone-sized viewport.



Mobile employee portal reference screenshot.

Document control: This SOP describes the LeaveFlow behavior shown in the sanitized screenshots captured from the local app. Update this PDF after workflow, policy, role, notification, or reporting changes.